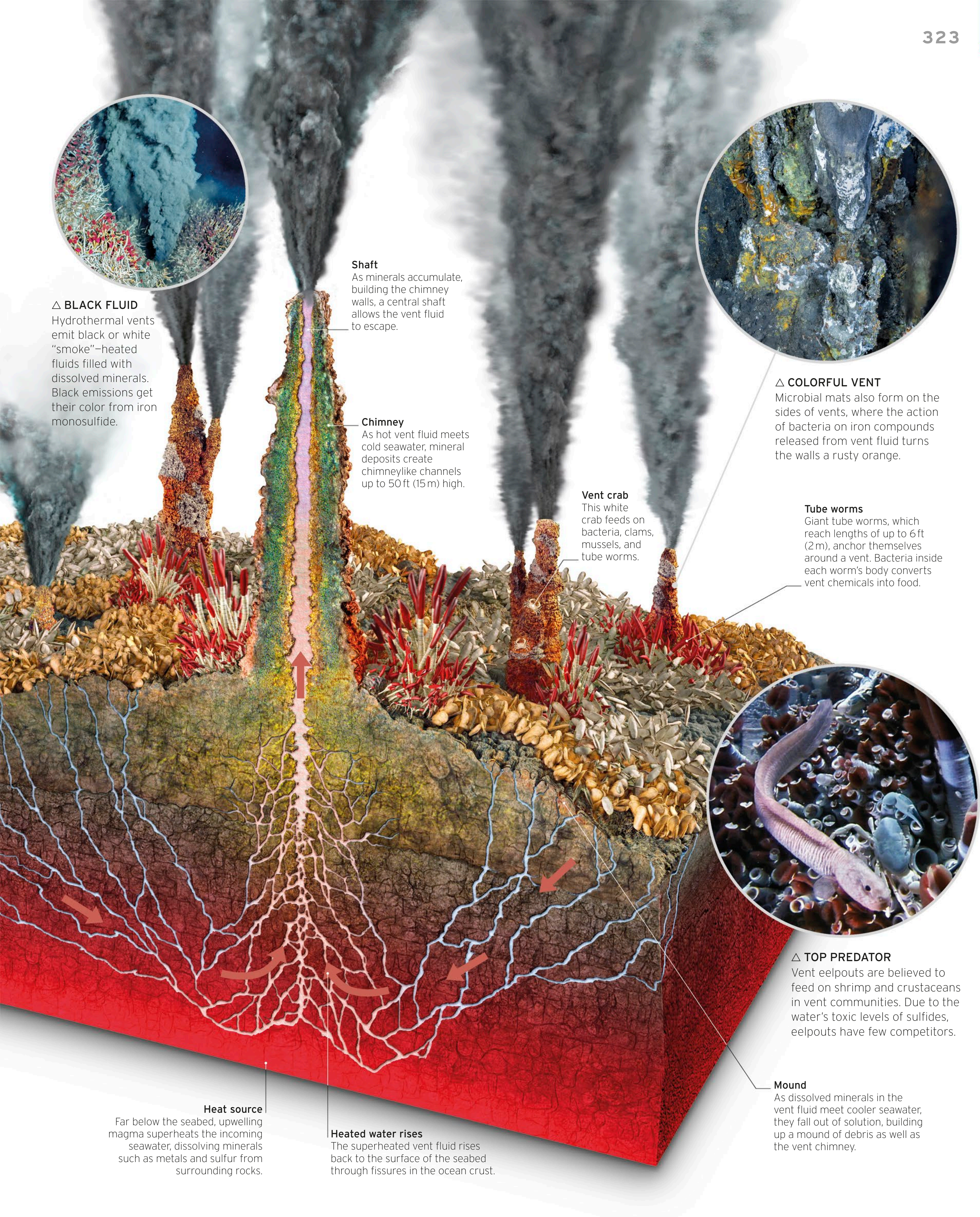

△ **BLACK FLUID**
Hydrothermal vents emit black or white "smoke"—heated fluids filled with dissolved minerals. Black emissions get their color from iron monosulfide.

△ **COLORFUL VENT**
Microbial mats also form on the sides of vents, where the action of bacteria on iron compounds released from vent fluid turns the walls a rusty orange.

△ **TOP PREDATOR**
Vent eelpouts are believed to feed on shrimp and crustaceans in vent communities. Due to the water's toxic levels of sulfides, eelpouts have few competitors.